

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) - Setup & Troubleshooting

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) adds a second layer of security to your Blossom Banking login. After entering your password correctly, you will be prompted for a one-time verification code. This document covers setup, supported methods, and how to resolve common issues.

1. Supported MFA Methods

- SMS text message - 6-digit code sent to your registered mobile number.
- Email one-time code - 6-digit code sent to your registered email.
- Authenticator app - time-based one-time password (TOTP) via Google Authenticator, Authy, Microsoft Authenticator, or any TOTP-compatible app.
- Phone call - automated call reads a 6-digit code (for accessibility needs).

2. Setting Up an Authenticator App (Recommended)

Authenticator apps are the most secure and reliable MFA method because they work offline and are not vulnerable to SIM-swap attacks.

Steps:

- Log in to Online Banking and navigate to Settings > Security > Two-Factor Authentication.
- Select 'Authenticator App' and click 'Set Up'.
- A QR code and a 16-character backup key are displayed.
- Open your authenticator app, tap '+' or 'Add account', and scan the QR code.
- Enter the 6-digit code shown in your app to confirm the setup.
- Store your 16-character backup key in a secure location (password manager or printed copy).
- MFA via authenticator is now your primary method.

Note: Your backup key can be used to restore the authenticator if you lose your phone. Keep it private - anyone with this key can generate your MFA codes.

3. Setting Up SMS MFA

- Go to Settings > Security > Two-Factor Authentication.
- Select 'Text Message (SMS)' and click 'Set Up'.
- Confirm or enter your mobile number and click 'Send Code'.
- Enter the 6-digit code received by text.
- SMS MFA is now active.

Important: SMS-based MFA is less secure than an authenticator app due to SIM-swap risk. We recommend using an authenticator app whenever possible.

4. MFA Code Validity

- SMS and email codes are valid for 10 minutes from the time of delivery.
- Authenticator app codes refresh every 30 seconds (TOTP standard).
- A code can only be used once. Requesting a new code invalidates the previous one.

- After 5 failed MFA attempts, the account is locked (see Account Lockout Policy).

5. Troubleshooting: Code Not Arriving

SMS code not received:

- Wait up to 60 seconds - carrier delays can occur.
- Confirm your mobile number is correct in Settings > Profile > Contact Information.
- Check that your phone has signal and is not in airplane mode.
- If your number changed, contact Member Support to update it before the next login.
- Use the 'Resend Code' button (available after 30 seconds).
- Switch to email MFA as a fallback if SMS is persistently unavailable.

Email code not received:

- Check your spam and junk folder.
- Ensure noreply@blossombanking.com is on your safe senders list.
- Email codes can take up to 3 minutes during high-traffic periods.
- If your email is inaccessible, use the phone-call MFA option or contact Member Support.

Authenticator app code rejected:

- Time sync is critical - ensure your phone's clock is set to automatic/network time.
- On Google Authenticator: open the app menu > 'Time correction for codes' > 'Sync now'.
- If the issue persists, remove and re-add the Blossom Banking entry using your backup key.
- Contact Member Support if you do not have your backup key.

6. Lost or New Phone - Recovering MFA Access

If you no longer have access to your MFA device, contact Member Support. You will need to verify your identity using non-MFA factors. After verification, support can temporarily disable MFA so you can log in and re-enroll a new device.

Steps after losing your MFA device:

- Call Member Support at 1-800-256-7766.
- Complete identity verification: name, DOB, last four of account, and security question.
- Agent temporarily suspends MFA on your account (valid for 24 hours).
- Log in with your password only during the 24-hour window.
- Immediately set up MFA on your new device via Settings > Security.

7. Disabling MFA (Not Recommended)

MFA can only be disabled by contacting Member Support. MFA cannot be self-disabled via the portal to protect members from social engineering attacks. Disabling MFA requires the same identity verification as a password reset.

Note: Business accounts and staff accounts have mandatory MFA that cannot be disabled. Only personal consumer accounts may request MFA removal, subject to approval.